

POWER TO PANCHAYATS

Gujarat, the land of Mahatma Gandhi and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, is a shining example of the smooth devolution of power and resources to panchayats leading to all-round rural development, and empowered, Aatmanirbhar villages

Gujarat has a three-tier Panchayati Raj structure with 33 district panchayats, 248 taluka panchayats and 14,529 gram panchayats. Significantly, there are more women than men representatives in the state's Panchayati Raj system, governed by Gujarat Panchayat Act 1993. Of a total of 1,38,947 elected officials in Panchayati Raj institutions (PRIs), 73120 elected officials are women against 65827 men. This amounts to representation of 52% women against 48% men in PRIs.

PANCHAYAT MAHA SAMMELAN

Addressing a recent mammoth event 'Gujarat Panchayat Mahasammelan: Aapnu Gaam, Aapnu Gaurav' attended by 1,06,318 PR representatives in the state, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said that a robust Panchayati Raj infrastructure is the key to fulfilling Bapu's dream of Gram Swaraj. Referring to women's empowerment where men no longer run PRIs in the name of their elected sarpanch wives, he said that all elected women members, especially women sarpanchs should take over the responsibility of administration of gram panchayats."We don't need a system of SP (Sarpanch Pati) in administration of villages, but let woman sarpanch herself do all the work."

The Prime Minister directly communicated with all the village representatives and gave them valuable suggestions to ensure better development of rural areas. Emphasising on 75 ways to mark the 75th year of Indian Independence, he asked them to plant 75 trees in every village during the "Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav". He also advised them to celebrate the foundation day of their village school by cleaning it and encouraging children to study.



They should ensure good standard of education and cleanliness; no eligible student should drop out from the school or anganvadi. At least one villager should visit the school daily to see for himself how it's operating.

He suggested taking out 75 prabhat feri (morning processions) in the village during this period. Modi asked them to gather all villagers and hold 75 programmes that can pave the way for the holistic development of their village. Apart from stressing on cattle vaccination, adopting LED lighting to save electricity and mobilisation of retired government employees for welfare of villages, he appealed to the panchayat members to alert people about the